

World Cup Predictions - Semis & Final

Name: _____

Date: _____

2. Language toolbox

A1-A2 - simple version

Certainty	Phrase	Example
Sure	will / won't	<i>France will win.</i>
Not sure	maybe, I think, probably	<i>Maybe Spain will win. / I think Morocco will lose.</i>

Quick drill: give students 4-5 sentence starters (*I think... / Maybe... / ... will win because...*) and have them complete orally in pairs before the speaking task.

B1-B2 - fuller range

Degree of certainty	Language	Example
Very sure	will, be going to, be bound to	<i>Argentina are bound to reach the final.</i>
Likely	probably, be likely to	<i>England are likely to struggle against Argentina.</i>
Possible	might, could, may	<i>Belgium might cause an upset.</i>
Doubtful	unlikely to, I doubt	<i>I doubt Morocco can beat Spain.</i>
Opinion hedges	I reckon, my guess is, if you ask me	<i>My guess is it'll go to penalties.</i>

3. Speaking task (8-10 min)

Pairs or small groups. Each student: 1. Predicts the winner of **both** semifinals, with one reason each (form, key player, past results). 2. Predicts the **finalist pairing** and who lifts the trophy. 3. (B1-B2 only) Predicts the **score** of the final and who wins the Golden Boot (top scorer) – encourage hedged language: *"I reckon it'll be close, maybe 2-1."*

4. Feedback round (3-5 min)

5. Optional extension (B1-B2)

Written follow-up: 3-4 sentences justifying predictions, to be checked against results after the final on July 19 – good bookend if you want a "were we right?" wrap-up activity later in the stay.

6. Written exercises (10 min)

A. Gap-fill - will / might / could / won't

Complete each sentence with the correct word from the box: *will · won't · might · could*

1. I think France _____ win – they're playing really well.
2. Spain _____ possibly beat Belgium, but it's not certain.
3. I don't think Norway _____ win the whole tournament.
4. It _____ go to penalties – nobody knows yet.

B. Write your own predictions

Using at least 3 different phrases from the language toolbox (Section 2), write 4-5 sentences predicting how the semifinals and final will go.

C. After the results - reflection (for later in the stay)

Once the final is played: were you right? Write 2-3 sentences using "*I said ... would ...*" to compare your prediction with what actually happened.

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Before class

Fill in the confirmed team names once each round is decided: - Quarterfinals played July 9-11 semifinalists known before you arrive (July 10). - Semifinals played July 14-15 finalists known partway through the stay.

Semifinal 1 (July 14): winner of France/Morocco vs winner of Spain/Belgium **[UPDATE]**

Semifinal 2 (July 15): winner of Norway/England vs winner of Argentina/Egypt/Switzerland/Colombia **[UPDATE]**

1. Warm-up (2 min)

Draw the bracket on the board (or hand out) with the two confirmed semifinals. Ask: *Who do you think will win?* Take a couple of quick oral guesses before introducing the language.

About this activity

Standalone speaking activity, ~15-20 min – two difficulty bands (A1-A2 / B1-B2)

3. Speaking task (8-10 min)

Circulate and note good/incorrect uses of the target structures for brief on-the-spot correction rather than interrupting the flow.

4. Feedback round (3-5 min)

Quick show of hands: who predicted which finalist? Who predicted the eventual winner (if already known)? Natural way to recycle the language: *"I said France would win, but I was wrong / I was right!"* – note this also sneaks in reported speech / past modal (*would*) for B1-B2 students if you want to extend.

C. After the results - reflection (for later in the stay)

Built from the confirmed quarterfinal matchups as of July 7, 2026 (France/Morocco – Boston, July 9; Spain/Belgium – Los Angeles, July 10; Norway/England and Argentina/Egypt–Switzerland/Colombia – July 11). Update the bracket once results come in.

A. Gap-fill - will / might / could / won't

1. 1. will 2. could 3. will 4. might